Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Llys Gwyn House Limited

Llysgwyn House Residential Home, 21 Caecerrig Road Pontarddulais, Swansea, SA4 8PE

01792882353

The inspection visit took place on 15/07/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	Llysgwyn House Limited
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care, Provision for learning disability
Registered places:	34
Main language(s):	Welsh and English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider promotes, anticipates, identifies, and meets the Welsh language and culture needs of people.

Ratings:

Well-being	Good
Care & Support	Good
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

Llys Gwyn House is a residential care home located in Pontarddulais, Swansea, providing residential care and support for older adults, including people living with dementia and age-related conditions, in a comfortable environment that promotes wellbeing and independence.

Well-being is good because people are supported to make choices, maintain important relationships and take part in meaningful activities that matter to them. People told us they feel safe, respected and well cared for, while relatives and professionals described the service as, responsive and welcoming. The appointment of a well-being co-ordinator has increased opportunities for engagement and community involvement, helping people to enjoy positive experiences and achieve outcomes that are important to them.

Care and support is good because people receive person-centred care from staff who understand their needs and preferences. Care plans are regularly reviewed, concerns are escalated promptly

and people have access to the healthcare support they need. Positive feedback from relatives and professionals demonstrates people receive good quality care and support.

The environment is good because people live in a safe, comfortable and homely setting that meets their needs and preferences. People have access to a range of indoor and outdoor spaces, bedrooms are personalised, and the home is well maintained. There is also evidence of continued investment to improve the environment and enhance people's experience of living there.

Leadership and management is good because effective governance and oversight systems help ensure people receive safe, consistent care. Leaders monitor the quality of the service through regular reviews, audits and feedback, and use this information to drive improvement. Staff describe managers as approachable and supportive, and benefit from regular supervision, training and development opportunities that help them meet people's needs.

Findings:

Well-being — Good

People live healthily and safely and with control over their lives. People are supported to make choices about how they spend their time. The recent appointment of a well-being co-ordinator is having a positive impact on people and increasing opportunities for meaningful engagement. During the inspection, we observed people enjoying baking and singing sessions and saw a group preparing to attend a local knit and natter group in the community. The co-ordinator demonstrated enthusiasm, creativity and a commitment to inclusion, with potential plans to develop one-to-one opportunities for people who prefer individual support. Residents' meetings have been reintroduced, giving people opportunities to share their views and contribute to decisions about life in the home. Staff demonstrate a strong understanding of promoting choice, with one member of staff stating, “We do promote choice, we make sure residents are very involved and we give them the atmosphere to express themselves and tell us exactly what they want.” Staff also recognised the importance of dignity and respect, with one telling us, “The service provides a safe, caring and welcoming environment where residents are treated with dignity and respect.” This was reflected in feedback from an external professional who commented, “There is a lovely feeling when you enter the building,” and a relative who told us, “She’s well looked after and is treated with respect

People are safe and protected from abuse and neglect. People told us they feel safe living at the home. One person said, *“I do feel safe here definitely. The night staff come and check on you’’.* Appropriate safeguarding, whistleblowing and complaints procedures are in place. Relatives told us staff listen and respond to concerns raised. One relative commented, *“We’ve brought a few little things up and they definitely listen and they definitely react.”* This indicates people and their representatives are confident concerns will be taken seriously and acted upon.

People are supported to cultivate safe and healthy relationships. People benefit from positive relationships with staff who know them well and understand their individual needs. One person told us, *“I’m happy here, they’re all lovely.”* Relatives also spoke positively about the relationships between staff and residents, commenting, *“All the regular staff they know her well.”* The home promotes and maintains open communication with families, with one relative telling us, *“Any little hiccup at all we will get a phone call, they’re very good I think.”* The service promotes the Welsh language through an active offer approach, with Welsh-speaking managers and staff available, bilingual signage throughout the home and information available in Welsh on request.

Care & Support — Good

People receive the quality of care and support they need to achieve their personal outcomes. People receive person-centred care and support that reflects their individual needs, preferences and life experiences. Personal plans contain detailed information about people's backgrounds, interests, relationships and communication needs, enabling staff to provide support that promotes wellbeing and respects their identity. Plans are reviewed regularly to ensure they remain relevant to people's needs. People have access to healthcare support, including a weekly GP ward round, and staff work effectively with external professionals to promote positive outcomes. We saw evidence of staff promptly escalating concerns relating to skin integrity, mobility and changes in people's health needs. Feedback about the service is positive. One external professional told us, *"The home works well as a team. Whenever I ask for information gathering or tasks that need to be followed up and speak to carers/management team, they act upon this as soon as they are able. They are always professional, friendly and approachable."* Relatives also commented, *"We are happy with the level of care the staff offer our relative," "The current staff look after mum extremely well and are very helpful,"* and *"They keep me informed at all times and they have the residents' interests as their main concerns."* The service also seeks people's views to improve their experience, including introducing a new menu based on feedback.

People are protected from harm and abuse through effective safeguarding arrangements and risk management processes. Safeguarding training is up to date for all staff, supporting a knowledgeable and confident workforce. Staff spoken with demonstrated a good understanding of their safeguarding responsibilities and how to escalate concerns appropriately. People benefit from personalised risk assessments that are regularly reviewed and updated to reflect changing needs.

People's medication is safely managed**.** Residents receive regular medication reviews to ensure medicines remain appropriate to their needs. Robust medication management systems are supported by monthly audits, controlled drug checks and spot checks. Staff check existing stock before ordering medicines, helping to reduce waste, and unused medicines are returned to the pharmacy at the end of each cycle. The service also receives regular pharmacy audits. PRN medicines are clearly documented and reviewed, with records showing minimal use where prescribed. Medication training compliance is high.

People's risk of infection is minimised. Infection prevention and control practices are embedded within the service. Infection control training compliance is high, and infection prevention and control is discussed regularly during team meetings. Staff were observed following appropriate infection control procedures and sufficient personal protective equipment was available.

Environment

Good

People live in an environment with appropriate and well-maintained facilities and equipment that supports their well-being and keeps them safe. The home is clean and welcoming, with a range of facilities that meet people's needs and preferences. Accommodation is provided over three floors and includes six lounges and two dining rooms, giving people opportunities to spend time in both quiet and social environments. One lounge includes a kitchenette, supporting people to maintain their independence and take part in everyday tasks safely where they wish. Bedrooms viewed during the inspection are personalised with people's belongings and reflect their individuality, helping to create a homely atmosphere. People also have access to adapted communal bathrooms and shower facilities that promote privacy, dignity and accessibility.

The environment supports people living with dementia using dementia-friendly signage, visual prompts and bilingual signage throughout the home. People can move around the service confidently and safely, with clear walkways and unobstructed fire exits observed during the inspection. Security arrangements are in place to promote safety while maintaining people's rights and dignity. These include secure door entry systems, visitor signing-in procedures and CCTV, with best-interest decisions in place where required.

People benefit from access to safe outdoor spaces. A secure internal courtyard allows people to spend time outdoors independently and includes flowers, plants, garden ornaments and a seating area. Residents have been involved in planting flowers, supporting meaningful engagement with the environment. Additional outdoor areas are secure and accessible, providing further opportunities for people to enjoy fresh air and outdoor space.

The provider demonstrates a commitment to maintaining and improving the environment. We observed refurbishment work during the inspection, including new carpets, redecoration and the introduction of new furnishings and artwork. While some areas appear dated, there is clear evidence of ongoing investment and a planned programme of refurbishment.

People can be confident that facilities and equipment are appropriately maintained. We reviewed health, safety and fire records, including evidence of regular equipment servicing, an up-to-date gas safety certificate and current five-year electrical certification. A maintenance system is in place to identify and address repairs. The kitchen is clean, organised and has achieved a food hygiene rating of 5 which is the highest possible score. Kitchen staff demonstrate a good understanding of people's dietary requirements, preferences and specialist needs, including modified diets and Speech and Language Therapy (SALT) recommendations. Information about people's nutritional needs is readily available, helping to ensure meals are prepared and served safely in line with professional guidance and individual requirements.

Leadership & Management — Good

People are supported to achieve their outcomes because the service provider has effective organisational arrangements, governance and oversight to ensure smooth operations and high-quality care. Comprehensive governance systems are in place to monitor the quality and safety of the service and support continuous improvement. We saw clear evidence of responsible individual involvement through quality-of-care reviews and quarterly governance visits and reports covering areas such as staffing, training, activities, safeguarding, complaints, operational challenges and general governance. Feedback is gathered regularly from people, relatives and staff through questionnaires and is used alongside a strong programme of audits to identify areas for improvement and monitor progress.

Audits provide oversight of key areas including personal plans, care records, body maps, skin integrity, food and fluid intake, weights, incidents, falls, activities, maintenance, complaints, compliments, supervision and appraisal processes. Records demonstrate findings are reviewed, actions identified and outcomes monitored. We saw evidence that lessons are learned and shared with staff to strengthen practice and improve outcomes for people. Notifications are submitted to CIW appropriately, demonstrating an understanding of regulatory responsibilities and a commitment to openness and accountability. Staff feedback generally reflects a positive and supportive culture. One member of staff told us, *"It's a good feeling anyway, very nice here, the manager is very approachable, can always speak to her if you need to be supported."* Another said, *"Most of the staff communicate well, support one another during busy shifts, and share a strong team spirit."* Staff consistently describe the service as supportive and focused on providing high-quality care.

People are supported by staff with the necessary expertise, skills and qualifications to meet people's care and support needs. Staff benefit from regular supervision and appraisal processes that support professional development and reflective practice. Records show supervisions focus on strengths, areas for development, current practice issues and agreed goals, supporting staff and managers to work together to improve practice. Staff told us they feel well supported and are confident concerns will be addressed appropriately. High levels of training compliance are maintained across mandatory and specialist training, helping to ensure staff have the knowledge and skills required to meet people's needs. We saw records of regular team meetings which reflect discussions around important topics such as infection prevention and control, dietary requirements and personal plan updates. People can be confident staff are recruited safely, with appropriate pre-employment checks completed. We saw staff are registered with Social Care Wales and are supported to achieve and maintain qualifications relevant to their roles, helping to ensure people receive care and support from a skilled and competent workforce.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

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